- **PLANNING:** Developing a care plan according to the need of the client
- **IMPLEMENTATION:** implementing the actions to restore the physical and mental health
- **EVALUATION:** Evaluating the client's response for nursing actions taken.

Methods of Assessment in Psychiatry

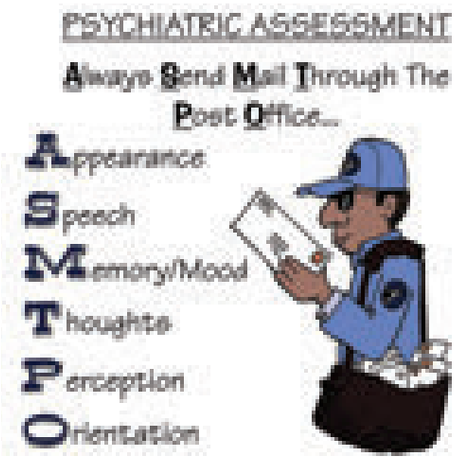
- History taking
- Mental status examination
- Neurological examination
- Physical examination
- Laboratory investigations
- Psychological tests

History Taking

History taking includes, patient's identification data, presenting complaints, history of present illness, past history of medical, surgical, and psychiatric, family history,Personal history, birth history, developmental history, occupational history, marital history and personal habits.

Mental Status Examination

Mental status examination includes general appearance, behaviour, speech pattern, mood, delusion, changes in perception like hallucination and illusion. And also assessment of higher mental functions of consciousness, attention, concentration, memory, orientation, intelligence and insight about illness.



Neurological Examination

Neurological examination for cranial nerve functions to be assessed.

Physical Examination

Physical examination includes head to foot assessment of the client.

Laboratory Investigations

Suggested for all psychiatric admissions. Complete haemogram, blood chemistry, serology studies, thyroid functions test, HIV antibody, urine analysis, imaging studies like chest x-ray, CT / MRI and also EEG and ECG.

Psychological Test

Usually conducted by clinical psychologist.

Documentation

Assessment information is documented in the nursing registers

Moreover, documentation is recognized by legal authorities

10.5 Psychosis and Neurosis

Psychotic disorders are a group of illnesses that affects the mind. These illnesses alter a person's ability to think clearly, make good judgments, respond emotionally, communicate effectively, understand reality and behave appropriately.

Neurotic disorders have common historical origin, about one fourth of the population in developed countries will suffer from neurotic disorders during its lifetime course.

Definition for Psychosis

Psychosis (psychotic disorders)are severe mental disorders that cause abnormal thinking and perceptions. People with psychoses lose touch with reality. Two of the main symptoms are delusions and hallucinations

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